Card Sorting Analysis – BYU CS Classes

Key Patterns

- Plan My Degree: Degree requirements, 4-year plans, graduation checklist, minor, prerequisite chains.
- Register for Classes: Class schedules/sections, registration how-to, add/drop, waitlists, prerequisite override.
- Course Info: Course pages, syllabi, textbooks, Canvas links, course evaluations.
- Help & Advising: TA hours, tutoring, office hours, advising appointments, contact advising, FAQs.
- Policies & Forms: Academic integrity, repeating courses, grade appeals, petitions/forms, code of conduct.
- Opportunities & Careers: Internship credit, capstone, undergrad research, clubs/events, jobs/internships, scholarships, career services, alumni.
- Resources: Labs/locations, computing/VPN, software licenses, accessibility, international students.
- People: Faculty directory, staff directory, contact us.

Frequent labels students used

- “Plan My Degree” or “Degree Planning”
- “Register”/“Register for Classes” (which is clearer than “Enrollment”).
- “Course Info”/“Course Information” for per-course materials and links.
- “Help & Advising” was usually combined; some split Help (TAs/Tutoring) vs Advising.

Splits

- TA hours vs Tutoring vs Office hours: sometimes was combined/split; think a single help hub with subpages.
- Canvas links: sometimes under Course Info, sometimes under Resources; prefer per-course placement.
- Course evaluations: low-use but expected under Course Info.
- Prerequisite chains: split between Plan and Course Info; recommend showing both in plan hub and on each course page.

Proposed IA Changes

- Navigation: Plan My Degree • Register • Courses • Help & Advising • Policies & Forms • Opportunities & Careers • Resources • People.
- Groupings: Align content to the clusters above; move career services under Opportunities & Careers.
- Cross reference search tool: Add a “What class should I take next?” tool in Plan

Priority Recommendations

- P1: Introduce a dedicated “Plan My Degree” hub with degree reqs, 4-year plans, and prereq chains.
- P2: Consolidate TA hours, Tutoring, and Office hours under “Help & Advising,” with quick search.
- P1: Update top navigation to the eight-item structure above.
- P7: Standardize course page template to include prereqs, textbooks, Canvas link, and syllabi.
- P8: Create a focused “Register for Classes” area with deadlines, add/drop, waitlists, and overrides.
- P4: Add a short glossary/FAQ to reduce confusion around Policies vs Forms.

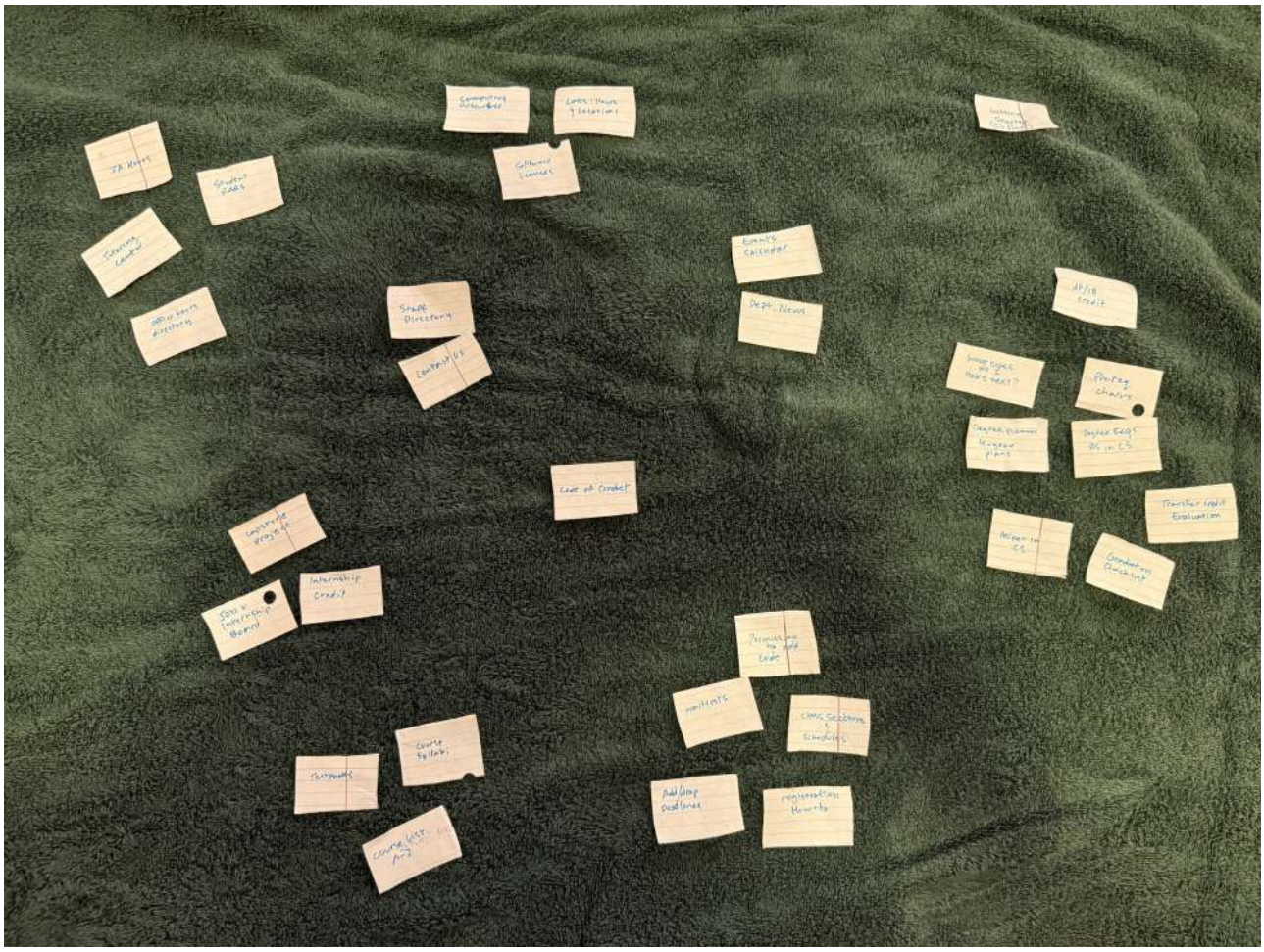
Appendix (brief)

- Consistency: about 75% of cards placed consistently across ≥60% of participants.
- Interesting quote: “I think in terms of ‘Plan → Register → Do class’.”

Card Sort Session Notes

P01 — Freshman, Pre-CS (exposure: None) — TMCB 10:00

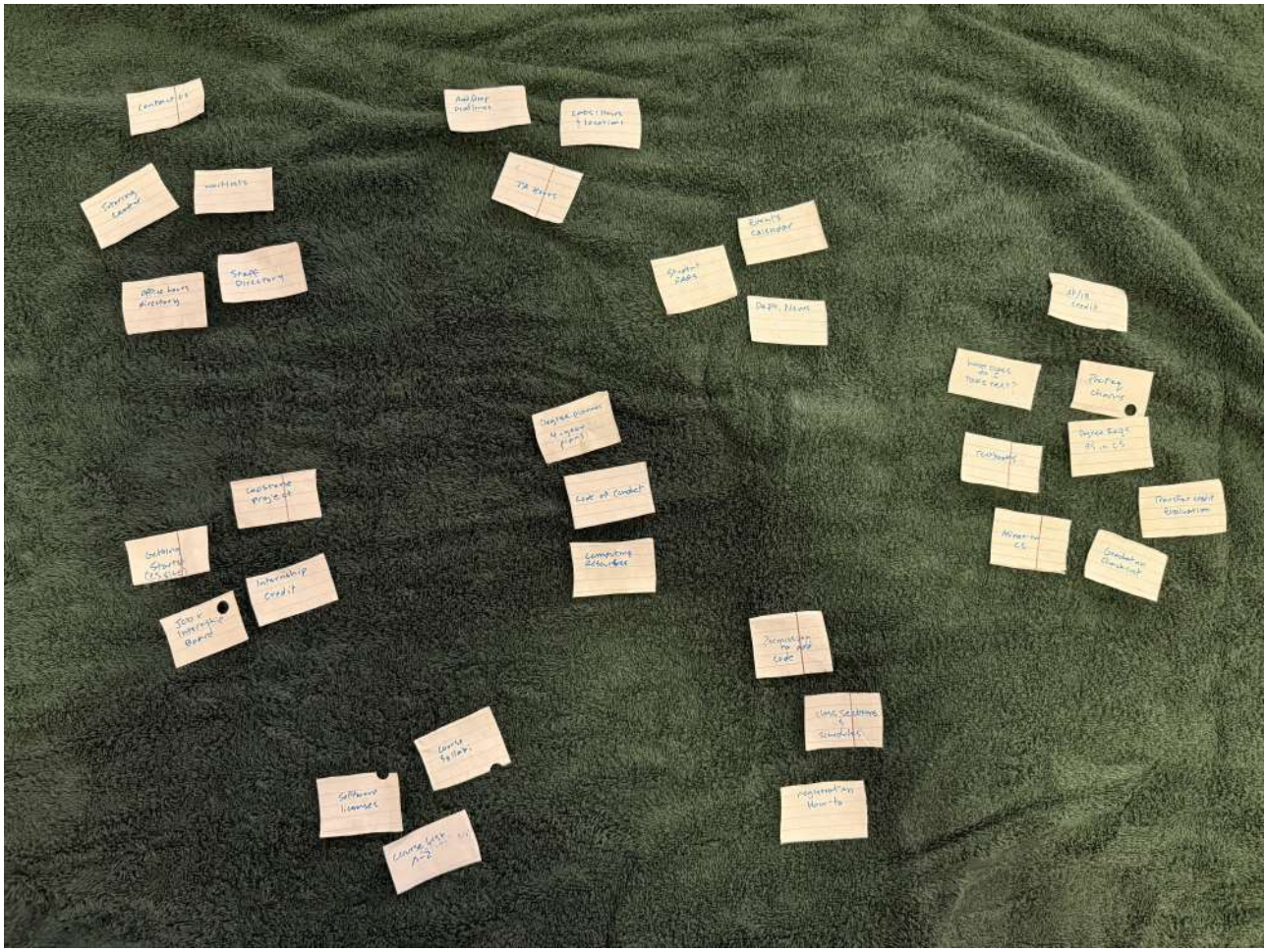
- Thoughts: plan first; keep registration together; help = TA/tutoring.
- Questions: are course evaluations public? do we need that readily accessible on the new website?
- Reasoning: prereq chains under Plan; Canvas links with Course Info.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan My Degree; Register for Classes; Course Info; Help & Advising; Policies & Forms; Opportunities; Resources; People.
- Photo:



P02 — Sophomore, CS (exposure: Some) — TMCB 10:10

- Thoughts: separate Register vs Plan; course pages should show prereqs + textbooks.
- Questions: where does Career Services go?
- Reasoning: TA hours with Support; evaluations under Course Info (low use).
- Groups (verbatim): Degree Planning; Registration; Course Information; Support & Advising; Policies and Forms; Careers & Opportunities; Tech Resources; People.

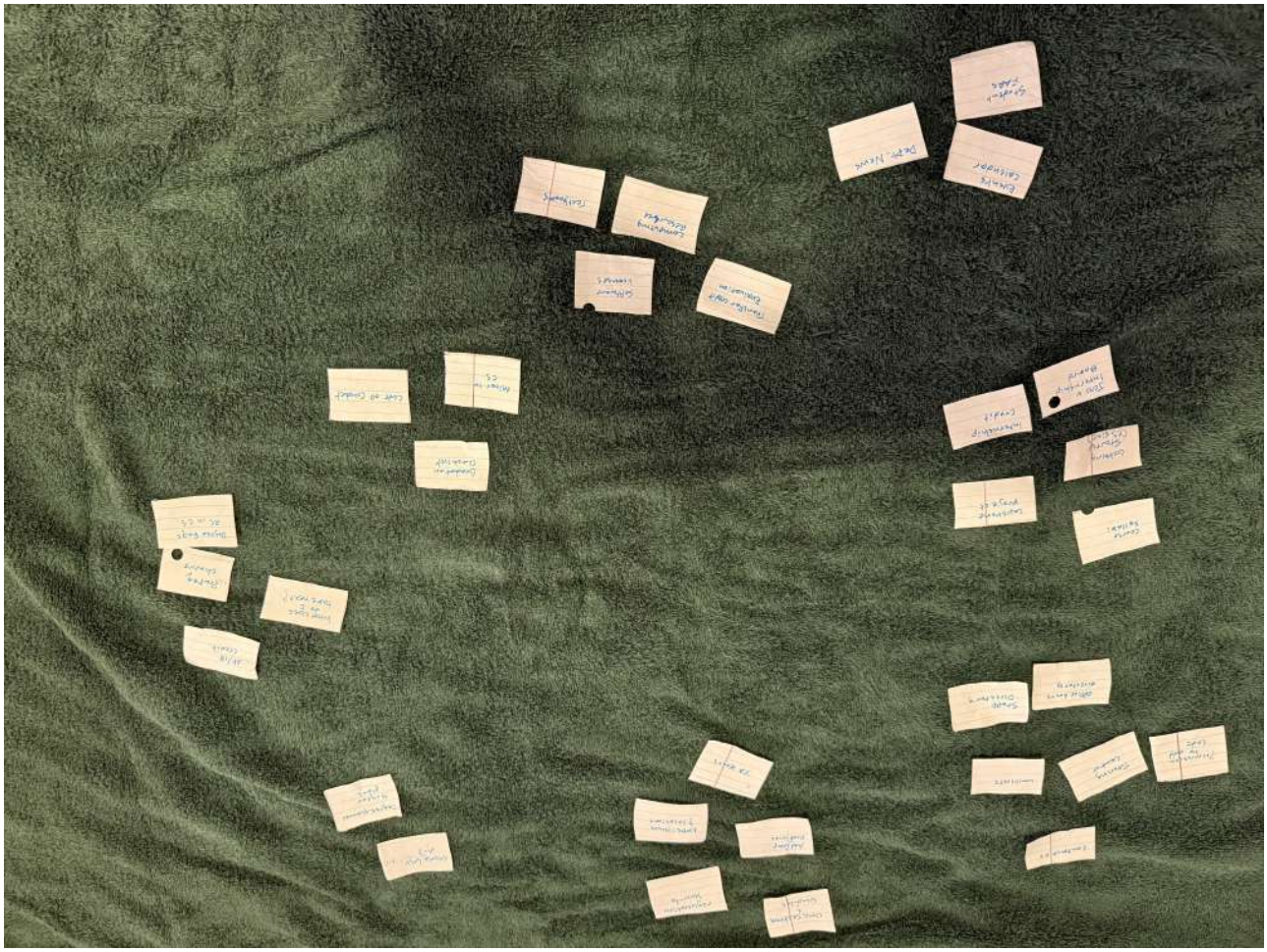
- Photo:



P03 — Junior, CS + Math minor (exposure: Frequent) — CS Lab 11:35

- Thoughts: resources = labs/VPN/software; advising ≠ tutoring.
- Questions: Canvas links per-course or general?
- Reasoning: Canvas links with Classes; override under Enroll.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan Degree; Enroll; Classes; Help (Tutoring/TA/Office); Advising; Policies • Forms; Opportunities & Career; Resources (Labs/Software); People.

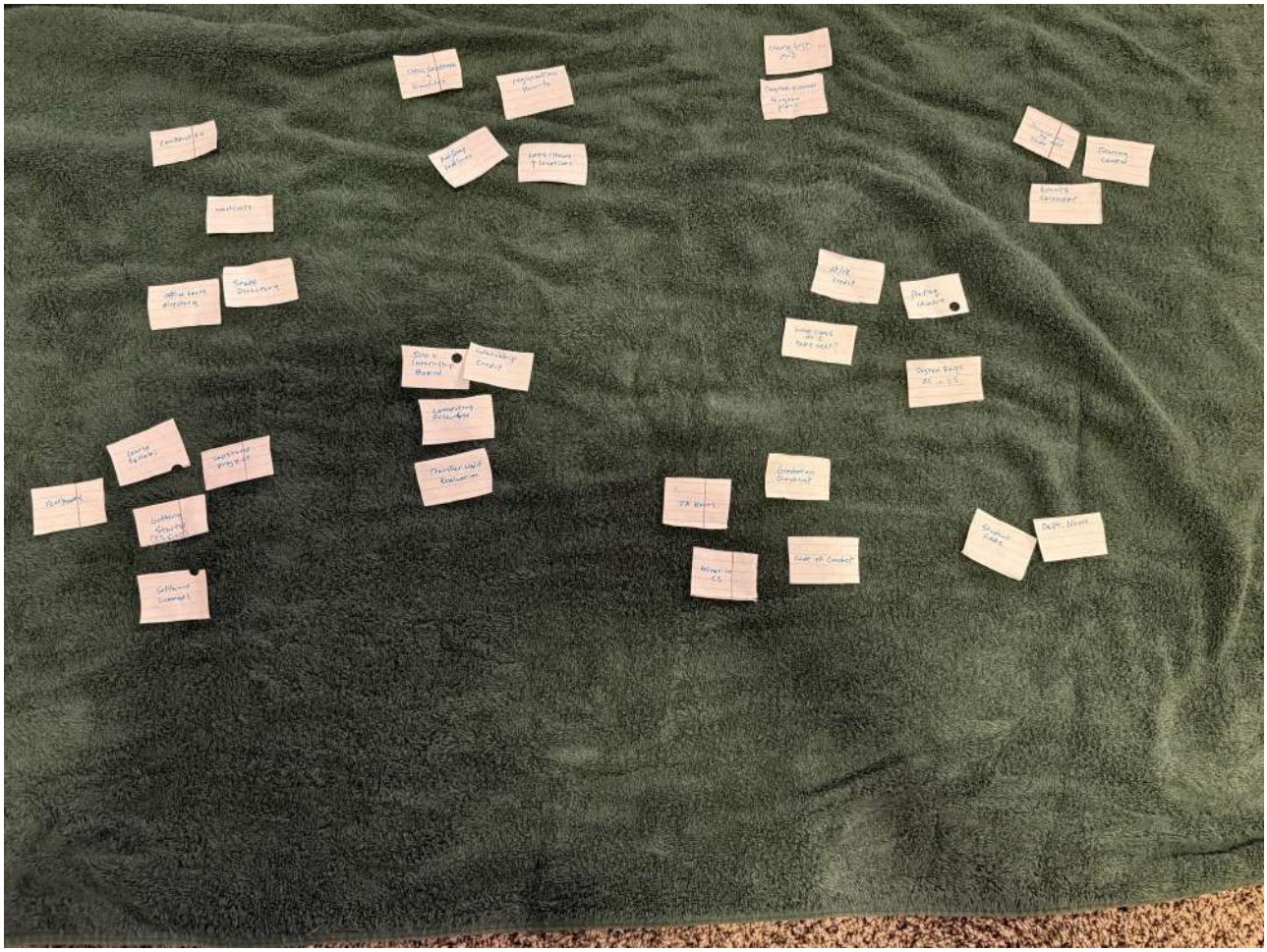
- Photo:



P04 — Senior, CS (exposure: Frequent) — CS Lab 11:45

- Thoughts: “Plan → Register → Do class.”
- Questions: where do evaluations live?
- Reasoning: evaluations in Course Info; rest mirrors P01/P02.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan; Register; Course Info; Help & Advising; Policies + Forms; Opportunities; Resources; People.

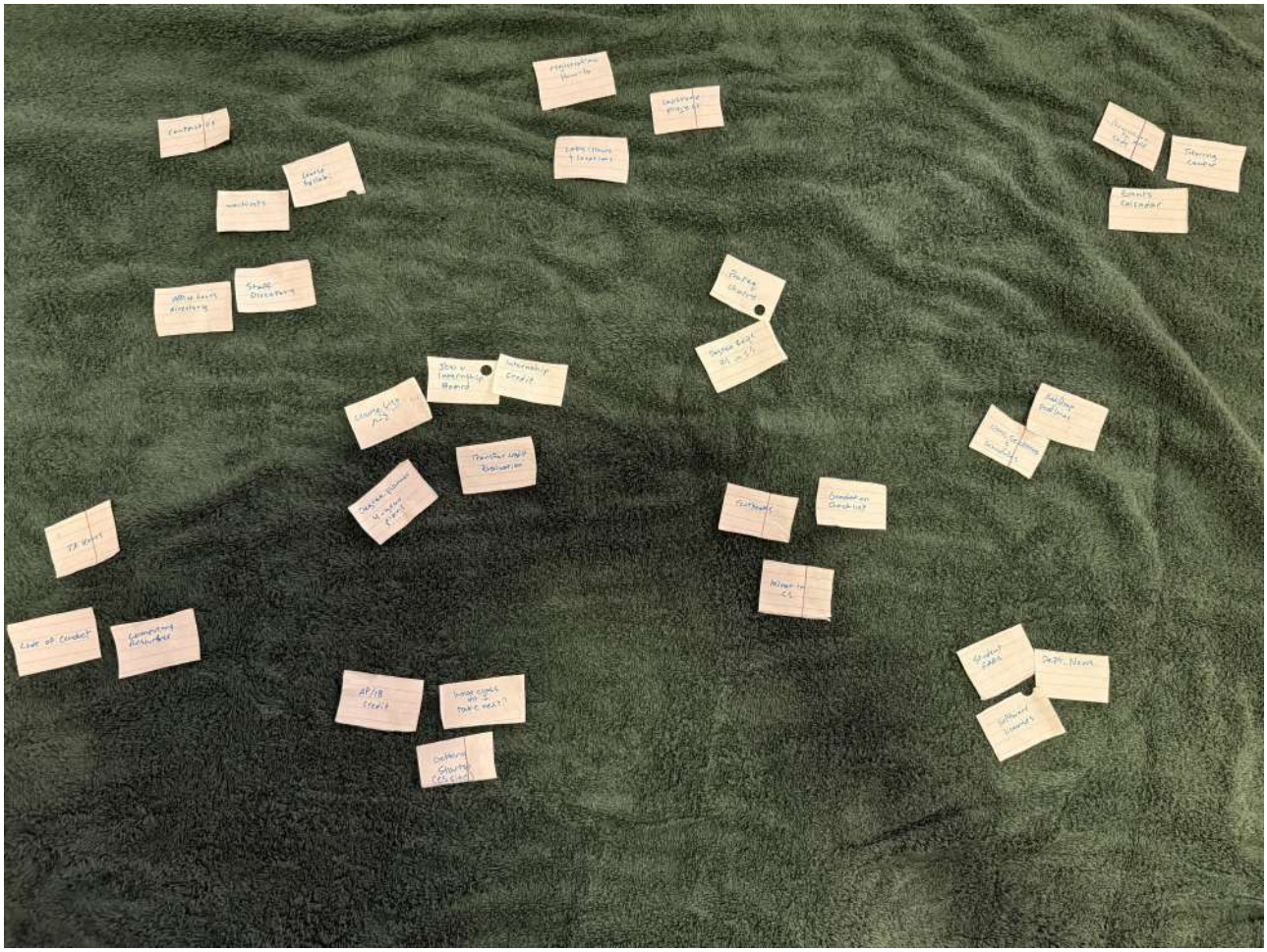
- Photo:



P05 — Sophomore, DS minor (exposure: Some) — TMCB 12:35

- Thoughts: prefers label “Help & Support”.
- Questions: code of conduct vs policies — kept together.
- Reasoning: Canvas links with Course Details; no new groups.
- Groups (verbatim): Degree Planning; Register for Classes; Course Details; Help & Support; Policies & Forms; Careers & Opportunities; Tech Resources; People.

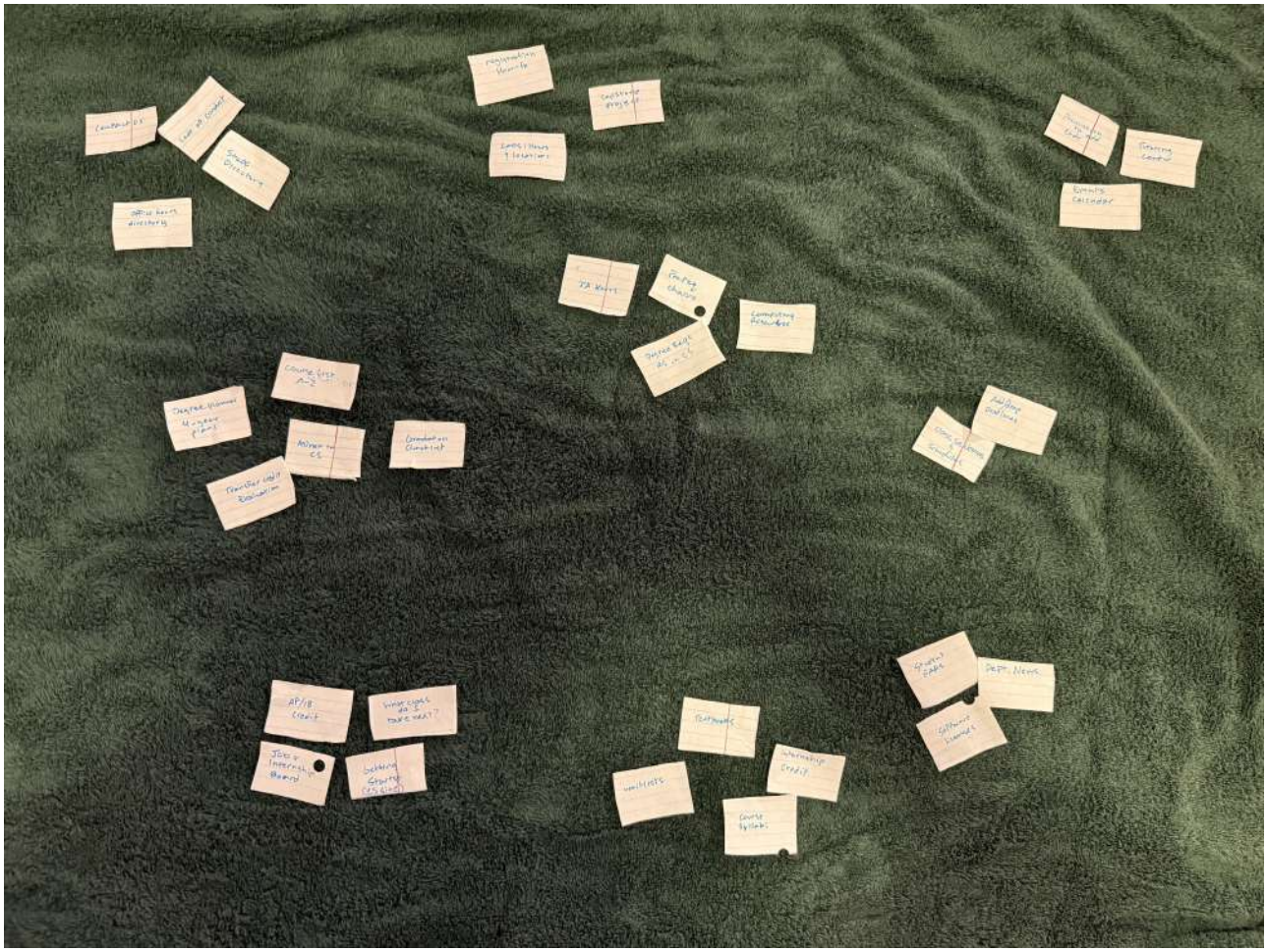
- Photo:



P06 — Freshman, Pre-CS (exposure: None) — TMCB 12:45

- Thoughts: just need Plan + Register prominent.
- Questions: TA vs Office hours (kept both under Help).
- Reasoning: prereq override under Register; matches prior structure.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan My Degree; Register; Course Info; Help & Advising; Policies & Forms; Opportunities & Careers; Resources; People.

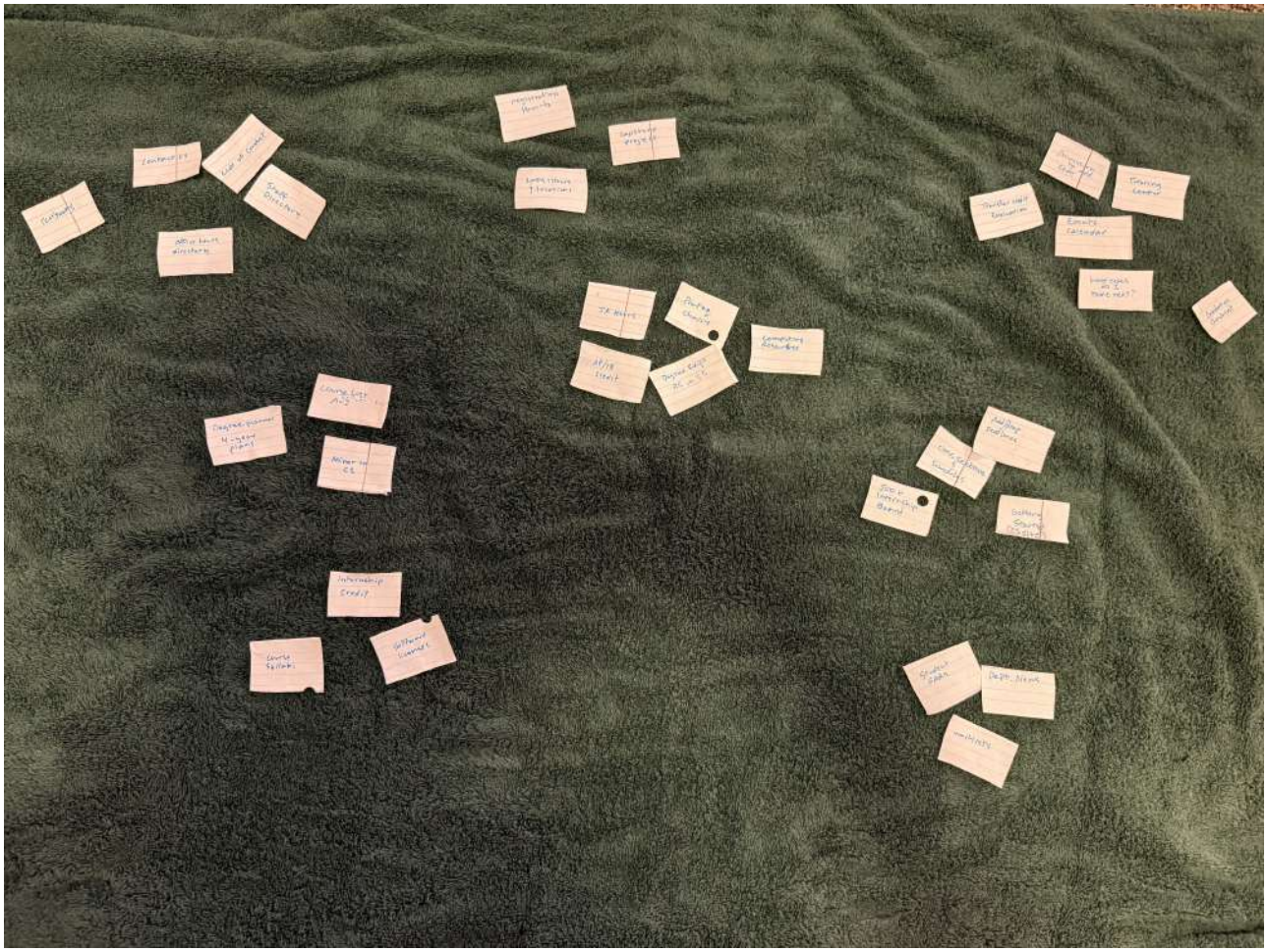
- Photo:



P07 — Junior, CS (exposure: Frequent) — CS Lab 1:15

- Thoughts: Opportunities and Careers should be unified.
- Questions: —
- Reasoning: evaluations with Course Info; follows converging pattern.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan Degree; Register; Course Info; Help & Advising; Policies & Forms; Opportunities & Careers; Resources; People.

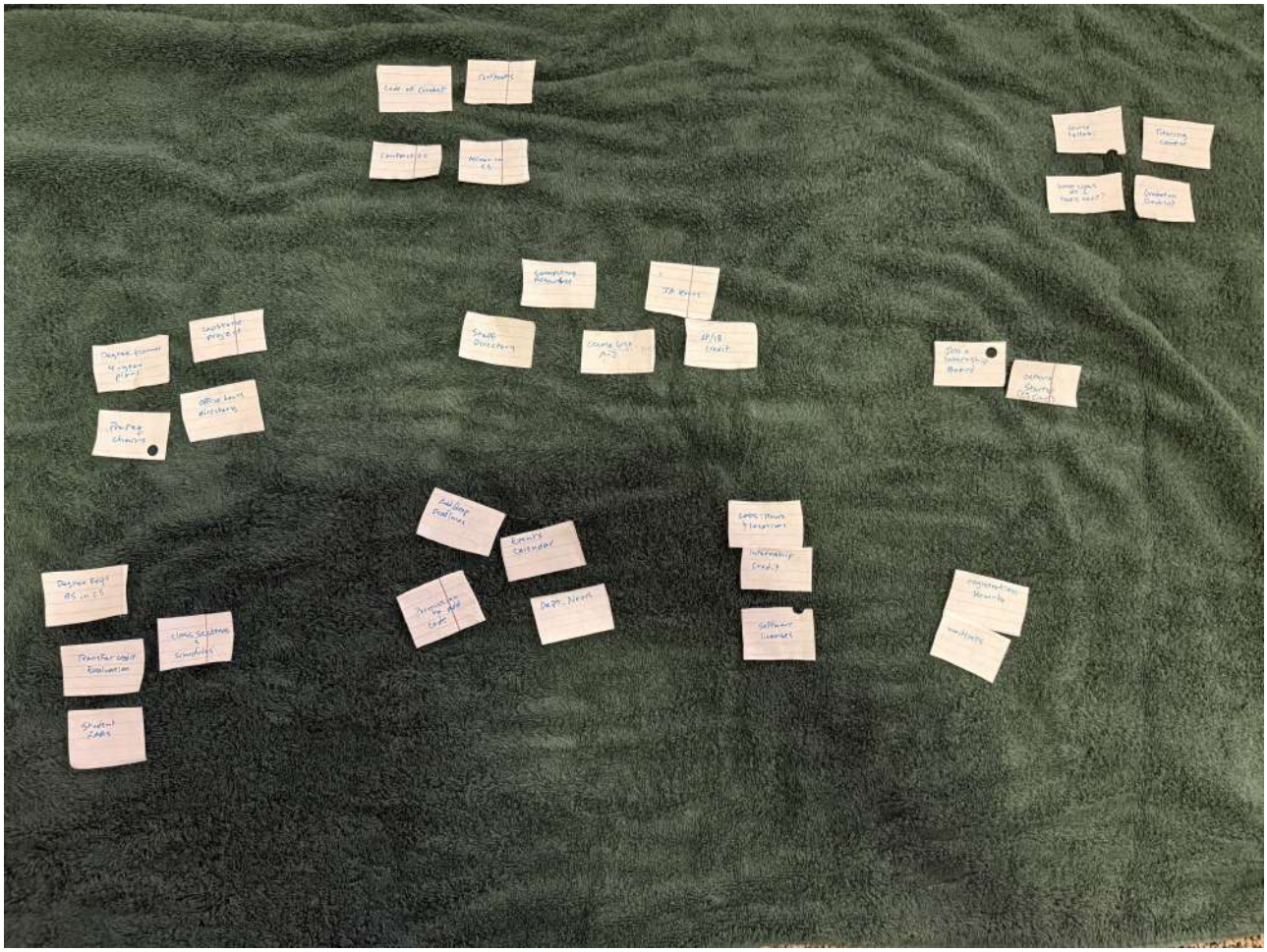
- Photo:



P08 — Senior, CS (exposure: Some) — CS Lab 1:20

- Thoughts: course pages need prereqs + Canvas link.
- Questions: —
- Reasoning: accessibility under Resources; identical to P06/P07.
- Groups (verbatim): Plan My Degree; Register for Classes; Course Info; Help & Advising; Policies & Forms; Opportunities & Careers; Resources; People.

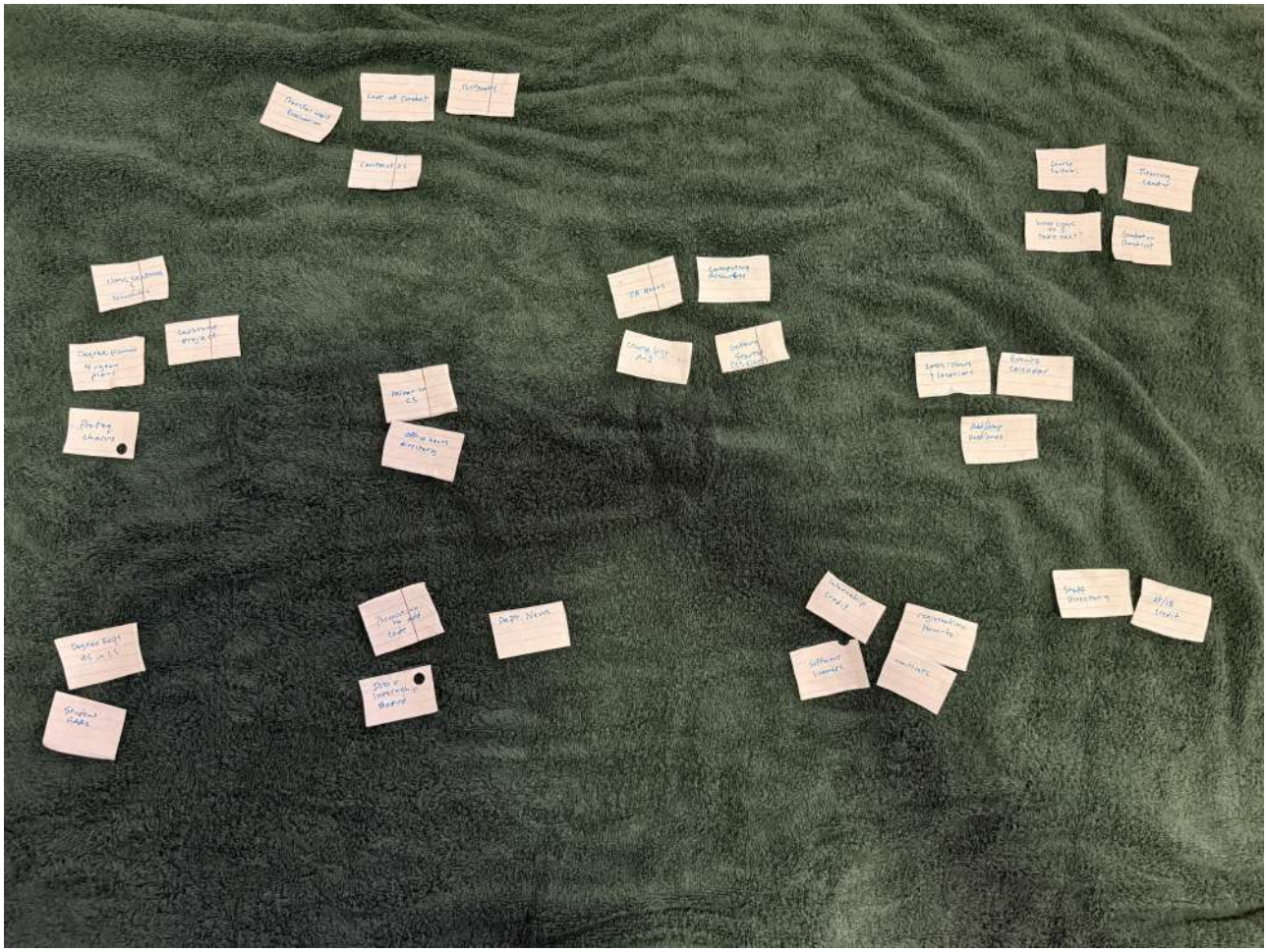
- Photo:



P09 — Graduate, MSCS (exposure: Some) — HBLL 4:45

- Thoughts: policies + forms together; advising ≠ TA help.
- Questions: —
- Reasoning: undergrad research to Opportunities; no new labels.
- Groups (verbatim): Degree Planning; Registration; Course Information; Help (TAs/Tutoring) & Advising; Policies & Forms; Opportunities & Careers; Resources; People.

- Photo: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